Leonardo da Vinci

Name: _____ Date: _____

INSTRUCTIONS

Read about the artist. Answer the questions in full sentences.
Then complete the drawing task at the bottom.

MEET THE ARTIST

Leonardo da Vinci was born in 1452 in the small town of Vinci in Italy.
He lived during the Renaissance, a time when art and science were changing quickly. Leonardo was a painter, but he was also an inventor, a scientist and an engineer.
He painted the Mona Lisa, a portrait of a woman with a small, mysterious smile, and The Last Supper, a huge painting on the wall of a dining room in Milan.
Leonardo filled thousands of notebook pages with drawings of plants, animals, the human body and machines, including designs for flying machines.
He often wrote his notes backwards, in mirror writing.
Only about twenty of his paintings survive, but his notebooks show how curious he was about everything.

QUESTIONS

1. Where and when was Leonardo da Vinci born?

_____

2. What was the Renaissance?

_____

3. Besides being a painter, what three other jobs did Leonardo do?

_____

4. What is unusual about the way he wrote his notes?

_____

5. Why do we know so much about his ideas even though few of his paintings survive?

_____

YOUR TURN

Be an inventor like Leonardo: sketch a machine that could help people, label its parts, and write its name backwards in mirror writing.

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Leonardo da Vinci - Answer key

1. In Vinci, Italy, in 1452.

2. A time when art and science were changing quickly.

3. Inventor, scientist and engineer.

4. He wrote backwards, in mirror writing.

5. Because he filled thousands of notebook pages with drawings and notes.

YOUR TURN:

Drawing task; no single answer.

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